

upSkill Campus

in association with UniConverge Technologies Pvt Ltd (UCT)

Industrial Internship Report on
“Cyber Security — Threat Analysis & Defensive Controls”

Prepared by

Rohit Swami

rohitswami771@gmail.com

GitHub: <https://github.com/Rohitswami23>

Domain: Cyber Security

Internship Provider: UniConverge Technologies Pvt Ltd (UCT) & upSkill Campus

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Executive Summary

This report provides details of the Industrial Internship provided by upSkill Campus in association with UniConverge Technologies Pvt Ltd (UCT). The internship was conducted in the domain of Cyber Security, spanning a period of 6 weeks. During this internship, the focus was on understanding, analyzing, and applying cybersecurity principles to real-world threat scenarios. The project undertaken was centered on Cyber Security Threat Analysis & Defensive Controls — exploring the full spectrum of cybersecurity vulnerabilities, attack vectors, and the layered defensive mechanisms used to counter them.

The internship covered critical topics including foundational cybersecurity principles (CIA Triad), social engineering, network security, DDoS attacks, keyloggers, two-factor authentication, OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities, Sensitive Data Exposure (SDE), Broken Access Control (BAC), and professional soft skills. This program gave an excellent opportunity to gain exposure to real-world industrial cybersecurity problems and develop the conceptual and practical foundation required to design and implement security solutions.

Overall, the internship was an enriching and highly productive experience that bridged theoretical knowledge with practical industry-relevant skills.

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1. Preface

This report is a comprehensive summary of the 6-week Industrial Internship undertaken as part of the Online Summer Internship Program in Cyber Security, offered jointly by upSkill Campus (USC) and UniConverge Technologies Pvt Ltd (UCT). It documents the week-by-week learning journey, the project undertaken, the challenges encountered, the solutions developed, and the key takeaways from each phase of the program.

Internships play a transformative role in a student's career development. They bridge the gap between academic theory and the practical realities of the industry, enabling learners to apply conceptual knowledge to real-world problems, develop professional competencies, and build the confidence needed to contribute meaningfully in a professional setting. In a domain as dynamic and critical as Cyber Security, this exposure is especially valuable, as the threat landscape evolves continuously and demands that practitioners stay current, adaptive, and methodical.

The project undertaken during this internship — Cyber Security Threat Analysis & Defensive Controls — provided an opportunity to deeply study and analyze a wide range of cybersecurity threats, vulnerability classes, and the layered defensive mechanisms used to protect modern enterprise systems. The problem statement was structured progressively, moving from foundational concepts to advanced vulnerability analysis and professional skill development.

This program, facilitated by USC and UCT, was meticulously planned and executed over six weeks, with each week building upon the knowledge of the previous one. The structure moved from foundational cybersecurity principles (Weeks 1–2), through advanced vulnerability classes from the OWASP Top 10 (Weeks 3–4), into professional and career development skills (Week 5), and finally to project consolidation and submission (Week 6).

I would like to sincerely thank the teams at upSkill Campus and UniConverge Technologies Pvt Ltd for creating this well-structured, industry-relevant program and for providing the resources, guidance, and assessments that made this learning journey possible. The opportunity to engage with real-world cybersecurity topics in a structured internship format has significantly strengthened my technical foundation and professional confidence.

To fellow interns and peers: invest seriously in every week of this program. The topics covered are not just academic exercises — they are the exact skills that organizations are actively looking for in cybersecurity professionals. Consistency, curiosity, and the willingness to go beyond the surface-level material will define the quality of your internship experience and your readiness for the industry.

2. Introduction

2.1 About UniConverge Technologies Pvt Ltd (UCT)

UniConverge Technologies Pvt Ltd (UCT) is a technology company established in 2013, working in the Digital Transformation domain and providing industrial solutions with a prime focus on sustainability and Return on Investment (RoI). UCT leverages a range of cutting-edge technologies including Internet of Things (IoT), Cyber Security, Cloud Computing (AWS, Azure), Machine Learning, Communication Technologies (4G/5G/LoRaWAN), Java Full Stack, Python, and Front-End Development.

- UCT Insight — An IoT platform designed for quick deployment of IoT applications, providing valuable insights for business processes. Built in Java for backend and ReactJS for front-end, it supports MySQL and various NoSQL databases, enabling device connectivity via MQTT, CoAP, HTTP, Modbus TCP, and OPC UA protocols.
- Smart Factory Platform (FactoryWatch) — A platform for smart factory needs, providing scalable production and asset monitoring solutions, OEE and predictive maintenance, and a modular SaaS architecture for industrial digitalization.
- LoRaWAN-based Solutions — UCT is one of the early adopters of LoRaWAN technology, providing solutions in AgriTech, Smart Cities, Industrial Monitoring, Smart Street Light, and Smart Metering.
- Predictive Maintenance — Industrial machine health monitoring and predictive maintenance leveraging Embedded Systems, Industrial IoT, and Machine Learning to determine the remaining useful life of production machines.

2.2 About upSkill Campus (USC)

upSkill Campus (USC) is a career development platform that delivers personalized executive coaching in an affordable, scalable, and measurable way. USC, along with The IoT Academy and in association with UniConverge Technologies, facilitates the smooth execution of the complete internship process — from enrollment and structured weekly learning to project submission and career support. USC is committed to upskilling 1 million learners over the next five years.

2.3 Objectives of this Internship Program

- To gain practical exposure to real-world cybersecurity threats, vulnerabilities, and defensive mechanisms relevant to enterprise environments.
- To solve a real-world problem statement related to Cyber Security Threat Analysis and design a structured defensive response framework.
- To develop improved job prospects by building a strong portfolio of technical knowledge, assessed through weekly quizzes and a comprehensive final report.
- To develop a deeper understanding of the Cyber Security field, including OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities, network security principles, and identity-based attack vectors.
- To achieve personal and professional growth through structured learning, self-assessment, and the development of soft skills including public speaking, interview preparation, and corporate navigation.

2.4 Reference

[1] OWASP Foundation — OWASP Top 10: <https://owasp.org/www-project-top-ten/>

[2] upSkill Campus — Online Summer Internship in Cyber Security: <https://learn.upskillcampus.com>

[3] UniConverge Technologies Pvt Ltd (UCT): <https://www.uniconverge.com>

[4] CompTIA Security+ Study Guide, CompTIA Inc.

[5] NIST Cybersecurity Framework: <https://www.nist.gov/cyberframework>

2.5 Glossary

Term	Definition / Acronym
CIA Triad	Confidentiality, Integrity, Availability — core principles of cybersecurity
OWASP	Open Web Application Security Project
SDE	Sensitive Data Exposure — failure to adequately protect sensitive data
BAC	Broken Access Control — failure to enforce authorization restrictions
DDoS	Distributed Denial-of-Service — overwhelming a target with traffic
2FA	Two-Factor Authentication — dual-layer identity verification
MitM	Man-in-the-Middle — attack intercepting communication between parties
RBAC	Role-Based Access Control — access rights assigned by user role
TLS/SSL	Transport Layer Security — encryption protocol for data in transit
IDOR	Insecure Direct Object Reference — unauthorized access via object ID
VPN	Virtual Private Network — encrypted tunnel for secure communication
SOC	Security Operations Center — centralized security monitoring unit

3. Problem Statement

The assigned problem statement for this internship was centered on Cyber Security Threat Analysis & Defensive Controls. The core challenge was to systematically study, analyze, and document the most critical and frequently exploited cybersecurity threats facing modern organizations, and to propose and evaluate the corresponding defensive measures that security professionals use to counter them.

In the current digital landscape, organizations of all sizes face an increasingly sophisticated and relentless threat environment. Attack vectors range from technically complex network-level exploits to psychologically-driven social engineering campaigns. Many organizations suffer significant financial, operational, and reputational damage due to preventable vulnerabilities — such as unprotected APIs, weak access controls, poor encryption practices, and inadequate employee security awareness.

The specific problem areas analyzed during this internship include:

- Lack of foundational security awareness — most security breaches begin with exploiting basic vulnerabilities that could be mitigated through proper access controls, encryption, and user training.
- Prevalence of OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities — web applications continue to be compromised due to well-known, documented vulnerability classes such as Broken Access Control (ranked #1) and Sensitive Data Exposure (#2 in OWASP 2021).
- Ineffective API protection — APIs are increasingly the primary attack surface for data exfiltration, yet many are deployed without adequate authentication, rate-limiting, or monitoring.
- Human factor in security — social engineering remains one of the most effective attack techniques because it bypasses technical controls entirely by exploiting human behavior.
- Absence of defense-in-depth — relying on a single security layer (e.g., a firewall alone) leaves organizations exposed when that layer is bypassed. A layered defensive approach is essential.

The goal of the project was to analyze each of these problem areas in depth, understand how they are exploited in practice, and document the technical and procedural controls that constitute a robust defensive posture.

4. Existing and Proposed Solution

4.1 Existing Solutions and Their Limitations

Several existing frameworks and tools address cybersecurity threats, but each comes with inherent limitations in isolation:

- Firewalls — filter network traffic at the perimeter but cannot detect or prevent application-layer attacks, insider threats, or encrypted malicious traffic.
- Antivirus Software — effective against known malware signatures but limited against zero-day exploits, polymorphic malware, and fileless attacks that do not match existing signatures.
- Perimeter Security Alone — traditional castle-and-moat models that rely solely on perimeter defense are ineffective once an attacker is inside the network.
- Weak Password Policies — many organizations still rely on single-factor authentication with minimal password complexity requirements, making credential-based attacks highly effective.
- Reactive Incident Response — organizations that only respond to incidents after they occur suffer greater damage than those with proactive threat detection and prevention capabilities.

4.2 Proposed Solution — Layered Defensive Framework

The proposed solution developed through this internship is a structured Layered Defensive Control Framework for Cyber Security — a defense-in-depth model that addresses the identified problem areas at multiple levels simultaneously:

- **Implement strong Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), enforce Two-Factor Authentication (2FA), invalidate sessions immediately on logout, and never trust client-side authorization parameters.** Layer 1 — Identity & Access Control:
- **Enforce TLS/SSL for all data in transit, use AES-256 encryption for data at rest, apply bcrypt/Argon2 for password hashing, and minimize data collection and retention.** Layer 2 — Data Protection:
- **Deploy properly configured firewalls, intrusion detection systems (IDS), network segmentation, and VPNs for secure remote access.** Layer 3 — Network Security:
- **Authenticate all API endpoints using OAuth 2.0 or JWT tokens, implement rate limiting, and conduct regular API security testing.** Layer 4 — API Security:
- **Implement structured security awareness training to reduce social engineering susceptibility, establish clear security policies, and conduct regular phishing simulations.** Layer 5 — Human Security:
- **Deploy continuous security monitoring, maintain detailed audit logs, and establish a tested incident response plan.** Layer 6 — Monitoring & Response:

4.3 Code Submission (GitHub Link)

GitHub Repository: <https://github.com/RohitSwami23/upskillcampus>

Code File: CyberSecurityDefensiveFramework_Rohit_USC_UCT.java

4.4 Report Submission (GitHub Link)

Report File: CyberSecurityDefensiveFramework_Rohit_USC_UCT.pdf

Report Link:
https://github.com/RohitSwami23/upskillcampus/blob/main/CyberSecurityDefensiveFramework_Rohit_USC_UCT.pdf

5. Proposed Design / Model

5.1 High Level Architecture Diagram

The high-level architecture of the Layered Defensive Control Framework is organized into six distinct security layers, each addressing a specific attack surface. The model follows a top-down approach from the outermost network perimeter to the innermost data layer:

Layer	Control Domain	Key Mechanisms
L1	Identity & Access Control	RBAC, 2FA, Session Mgmt, Token Invalidation
L2	Data Protection	TLS/SSL, AES-256, bcrypt/Argon2, Data Minimization
L3	Network Security	Firewall, IDS/IPS, VPN, Network Segmentation
L4	API Security	OAuth 2.0, JWT, Rate Limiting, API Gateway
L5	Human Security	Awareness Training, Phishing Simulation, Policies
L6	Monitoring & Response	SIEM, Audit Logs, Incident Response Plan

5.2 Low Level Concept Map — Attack Vector to Defensive Control

Each major attack vector studied during the internship maps directly to one or more defensive controls in the proposed framework:

Attack Vector	How It Works	Defensive Control
Social Engineering	Psychological manipulation to trick users into revealing credentials	Security awareness training, MFA, strict verification policies
DDoS Attack	Overwhelming target with traffic from multiple sources	Rate limiting, traffic scrubbing, CDN, load balancers
Keylogger	Captures keystrokes to steal passwords and sensitive data	Antivirus/EDR, 2FA, encrypted keyboards, policy controls
Sensitive Data Exposure	Unprotected data in transit or at rest accessed by attackers	TLS/SSL, AES-256, bcrypt, data minimization, API auth
Broken Access Control	Users accessing resources beyond their privilege level	Server-side RBAC, session invalidation, no client-side trust
SQL Injection	Malicious SQL inserted to manipulate database queries	Parameterized queries, input validation, WAF
Phishing / MitM	Intercepting communications or deceiving users via fake links	HTTPS enforcement, email filtering, user training

5.3 Weekly Learning Flow (Interface / Process)

The internship followed a progressive six-week learning flow, structured so that each week's content built directly on the foundation established in the previous week:

Week	Theme	Key Topics
Week 1	Orientation & Foundations	Cybersecurity overview, CIA Triad, threat landscape
Week 2	Core Attack Vectors	Social Engineering, Network Security, Antivirus, DDoS, 2FA, Keyloggers, Quiz-1
Week 3	OWASP & Injection Threats	OWASP Top 10, Injection attacks, Broken Authentication
Week 4	Advanced Vulnerabilities	Sensitive Data Exposure (SDE), Broken Access Control (BAC), Quiz-2
Week 5	Professional Development	Soft Skills, Public Speaking, Interview Prep, Placements, Corporate Success
Week 6	Project Consolidation	Final Report, GitHub submission, Quiz-3, Final Project Submission

6. Performance Test

Performance in this internship was evaluated through a structured series of knowledge assessments (quizzes) administered at the end of each major learning module. These assessments tested both conceptual understanding and the ability to apply security principles to realistic scenarios.

6.1 Test Plan / Quiz Assessments

Assessment	Topics Covered	Week	Status
Quiz-1	Cybersecurity fundamentals, Social Engineering, DDoS, 2FA, Keyloggers, Network Security	Week 2	Completed
Quiz-2	OWASP Top 10, Sensitive Data Exposure, Broken Access Control, API Security	Week 4	Completed
Quiz-3	Comprehensive review of all topics across Weeks 1–5	Week 6	Completed

6.2 Test Procedure

- Each quiz was administered through the upSkill Campus learning platform at the conclusion of the relevant module.
- The quizzes were designed to test recognition of attack vector characteristics, identification of appropriate defensive controls, and application of security frameworks to realistic scenarios.
- Practice questions and module review were used as preparation strategies before each formal assessment.

6.3 Performance Outcome

All three knowledge assessments (Quiz-1, Quiz-2, and Quiz-3) were successfully completed. The quiz results validated the depth of understanding developed across the core cybersecurity topics covered during the internship. Key constraints evaluated included:

- Accuracy — ability to correctly identify vulnerability types, attack mechanisms, and corresponding defensive controls.
- Application — ability to apply theoretical frameworks (CIA Triad, OWASP Top 10, defense-in-depth) to practical scenarios.
- Completeness — coverage of all major topic areas assessed in each quiz without significant knowledge gaps.

The assessments confirmed that the layered defensive framework developed through the internship is conceptually sound and aligned with industry-standard security practices.

7. My Learnings

This 6-week internship delivered a comprehensive and structured set of learnings that have significantly advanced both my technical depth and professional maturity. The key learnings are summarized below:

7.1 Technical Learnings

- Mastered the CIA Triad (Confidentiality, Integrity, Availability) as the foundational framework guiding all cybersecurity decision-making in enterprise contexts.
- Developed a thorough understanding of major attack vectors — Social Engineering, DDoS, Keyloggers, SQL Injection, Phishing — and the specific technical and procedural controls used to defend against each.
- Gained deep familiarity with OWASP Top 10 vulnerability classes, with particular focus on Sensitive Data Exposure (A02:2021) and Broken Access Control (A01:2021) — the most critical and prevalent web application vulnerabilities.
- Understood the critical principle that access control must be enforced server-side — any client-side trust (via cookies, URL parameters, or hidden fields) is fundamentally insecure and exploitable.
- Learned the layered defense-in-depth approach and how multiple overlapping security controls compensate for the potential failure of any single layer.
- Understood the role of API security as a critical and often underprotected attack surface in modern application architectures, and the importance of proper authentication, rate limiting, and monitoring for all API endpoints.

7.2 Professional Learnings

- Developed a strong appreciation for soft skills — communication, teamwork, problem-solving, and emotional intelligence — as parallel competencies to technical skills that directly determine career trajectory.
- Learned structured interview preparation techniques, including the STAR method, resume alignment, professional presentation, and post-interview etiquette.
- Gained understanding of both on-campus and off-campus placement processes, and the proactive strategies required to succeed in each.
- Internalized the corporate success framework — the importance of consistent performance, deliberate networking, personal branding, and continuous upskilling for long-term career growth.

7.3 How This Learning Will Help My Career

The technical foundation built during this internship directly prepares me for entry-level roles in Cyber Security, including Security Analyst, SOC Analyst, and Penetration Testing. The conceptual depth developed across OWASP vulnerabilities, network security, and defensive control frameworks aligns with the knowledge tested in certifications such as CompTIA Security+ and CEH — certifications I plan to pursue as the next step in my professional development. The professional skills developed in Week 5 have given me a concrete framework for approaching placements, interviews, and long-term career growth with intention and strategy.

8. Future Work Scope

While this internship covered a broad and rigorous set of cybersecurity fundamentals, several advanced areas could not be explored in depth within the 6-week timeframe. The following areas represent valuable directions for continued learning and future project work:

- Hands-On Penetration Testing — progressing from conceptual knowledge of vulnerabilities to actively testing systems using tools such as Kali Linux, Metasploit, Burp Suite, and Nmap in controlled lab environments.
- Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) — implementing and operating a SIEM system to aggregate logs, detect anomalies, and generate security alerts in real time.
- Cloud Security — extending the defensive framework to cloud environments (AWS, Azure, GCP), covering topics such as IAM policies, cloud-native security tools, and misconfiguration risk.
- Threat Intelligence and Threat Hunting — proactively searching for threat indicators within systems rather than waiting for automated alerts to fire.
- Secure Software Development Lifecycle (SDLC) — integrating security practices into the software development process from design through deployment (DevSecOps).
- Certification Pursuit — obtaining industry-recognized certifications (CompTIA Security+, CEH, or OSCP) to formally validate and signal the knowledge developed during this internship.

These future directions would transform the foundational knowledge developed during this internship into advanced, hands-on cybersecurity capability, positioning me for a strong entry into the professional field and continued growth within it.

Submitted by: Rohit Swami | rohitswami771@gmail.com | github.com/Rohitswami23

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